Who is the IO?
IOs as Intermediaries in Aid Networks

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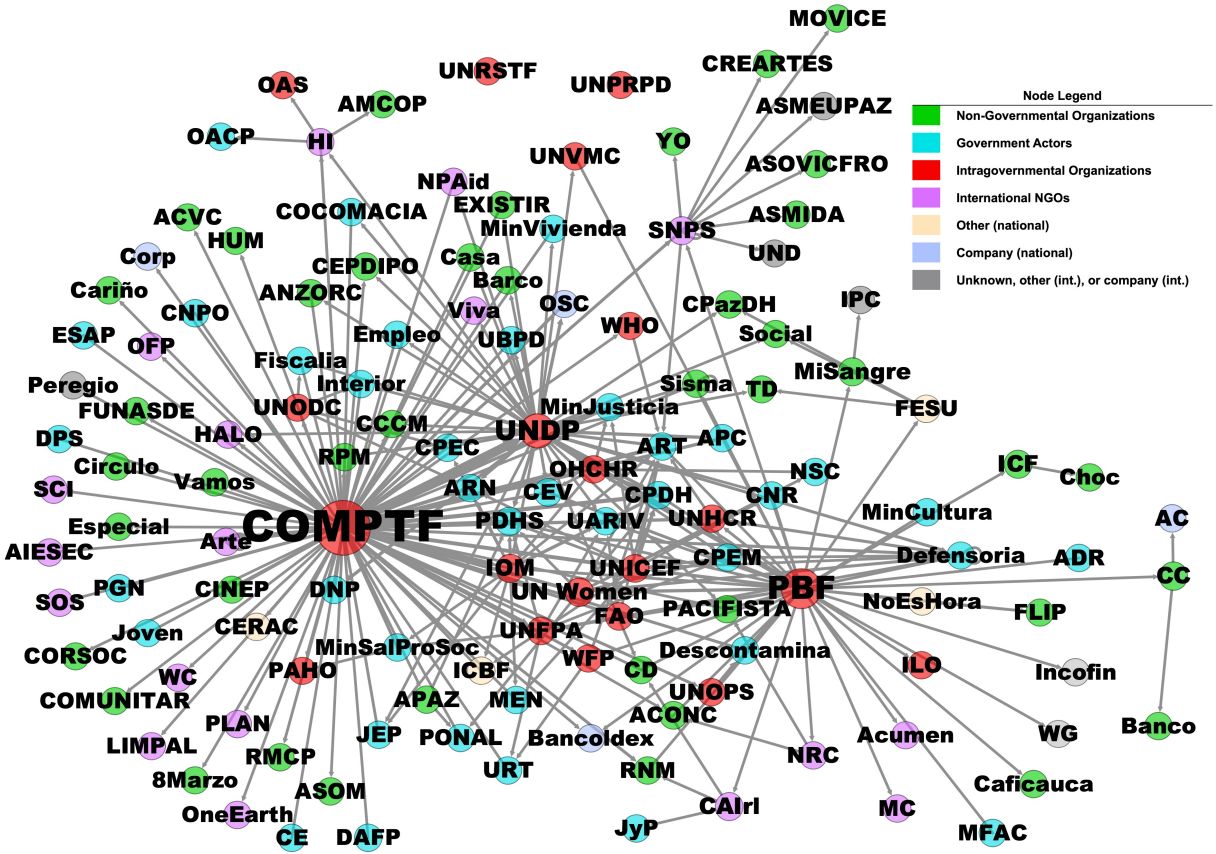
Outline

1. Motivation
2. Literature
3. Research Question
4. Research Design
5. Empirical Results
6. Conclusion
7. Appendix

IO Scholarship Focused on Member State-Bureaucracy & Policy Agenda Setting

IOs also Engage in Service Delivery Via Aid Contracts: Aid Network in Colombia


Node Legend
Non-Governmental Organizations
Government Actors
Intragovernmental Organizations
International NGOs
Other (national)
Company (national)
Unknown, other (int.), or company (int.)
MOVICE
CREARTES
ASMEUPAZ
ASOVICFRO
ASMIDA
UND
IPC
MiSangre
FESU
ICF
Choc
AC
CC
ADR
FLIP
Incofin
Banco
WG
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MFAC
MC
CAIrl
JyP
NRC
Acumen
RNM
Bancoldex
ACONC
UNOPS
Descontamina
ILO
CD
WFP
MinSalProSoc
ICBF
MEN
APAZ
PONAL
JEP
URT
DAFP
CE
OneEarth
ASOM
8Marzo
RMCP
LIMPAL
PLAN
WC
COMUNITAR
CORSOC
Joven
CERAC
SOS
PGN
CINEP
DNP
PAHO
AIESEC
Especial
Arte
SCI
Vamos
Circulo
DPS
HALO
FUNASDE
Peregio
ESAP
OFP
CNPO
Cariño
Corp
HUM
ACVC
COCOMACIA
OACP
HI
OAS
AMCOP
UNRSTF
UNPRPD
UNVMC
YO
NPAid
EXISTIR
MinVivienda
SNPS
Casa
Barco
CEPDIPO
ANZORC
Viva
OSC
WHO
CPazDH
Social
Empleo
UBPD
Fiscalia
Interior
UNODC
CCCM
CPEC
RPM
UNDP
MinJusticia
Sisma
TD
APC
ART
OHCHR
ARN
CEV
CPDH
CNR
NSC
PDHS
UARIV
UNHCR
COMPTF
IOM
UNICEF
CPEM
UN Women
FAO
PACIFISTA
PBF
MinCultura
Defensoria
NoEsHora
UNFPA
WFP
CD
UNOPS
ACONC
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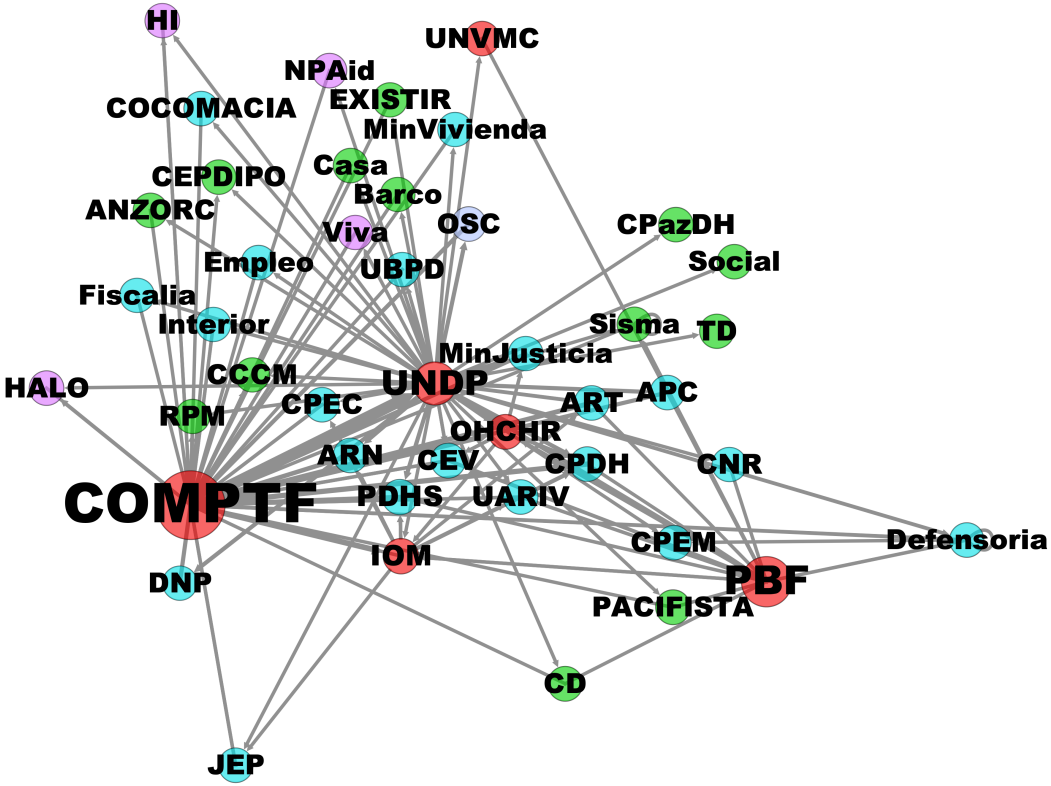
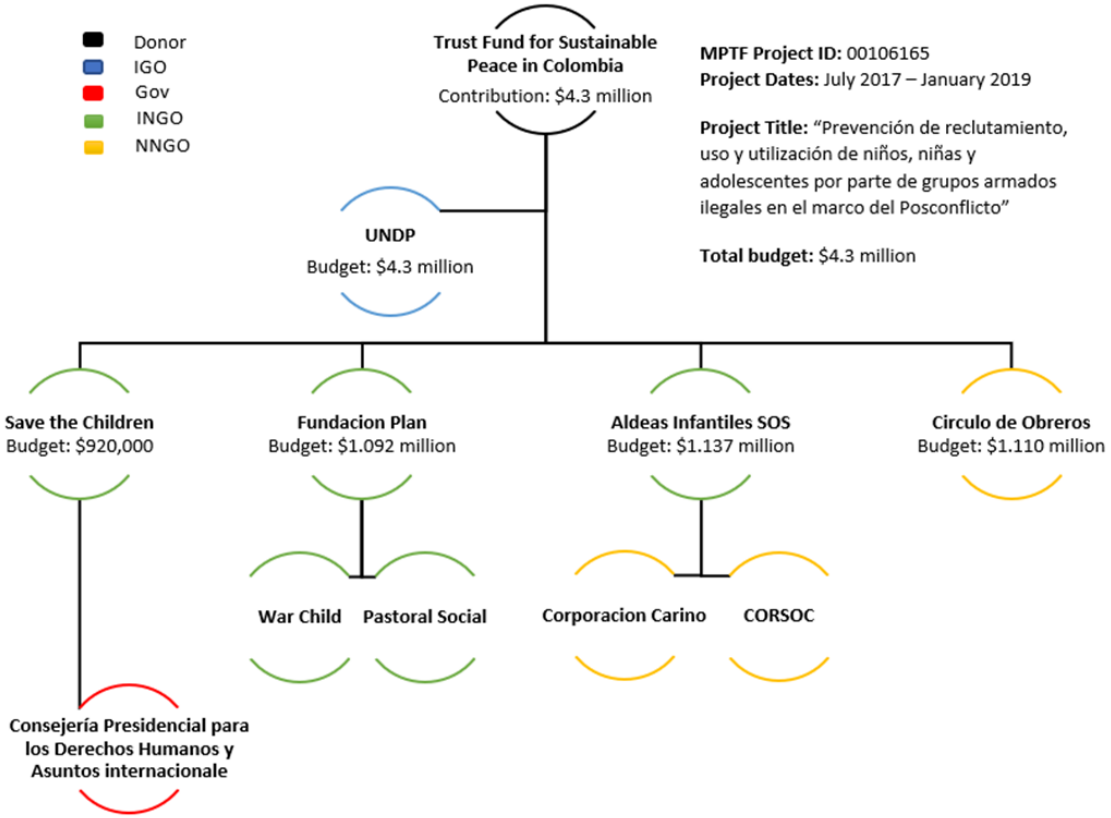
In Service Delivery, IO Contracting is Interdependent: UNDP, Host Governments, Donor Governments, other IOs, INGOs, NNGOs



Within a Single Project: IO as intermediary in complex delegation chain



Literature's Focus: IO Member States and Bureaucracy

- Rationalist
  - principals (member states) delegate to agents (IO secretariats) (Abbott and Snidal 1998; Hawkins et al. 2006; Rittberger et al. 2012; Hooghe and Marks 2014; Hooghe et al. 2017)
  - potentially long delegation chains (Nielson and Tierney 2003; Lake and McCubins 2006)
  - risk of slippage or shirking
  - assumption that logic of member state politics and preferences still dominate
- Constructivist
  - culture, norms, pathologies
  - bureaucracy has autonomy
  - pathologies emerge from member state-bureaucracy disconnect (Barnett and Finnemore 1999; Park 2018)
  - assumption that the IO bureaucracy innovates and disseminates norm
- Common focus
  - Member States + Bureaucracy
  - External orgs orchestrate agenda setting or provide third-party monitoring (Tallberg et al 2015, Abbott et. al. 2015)

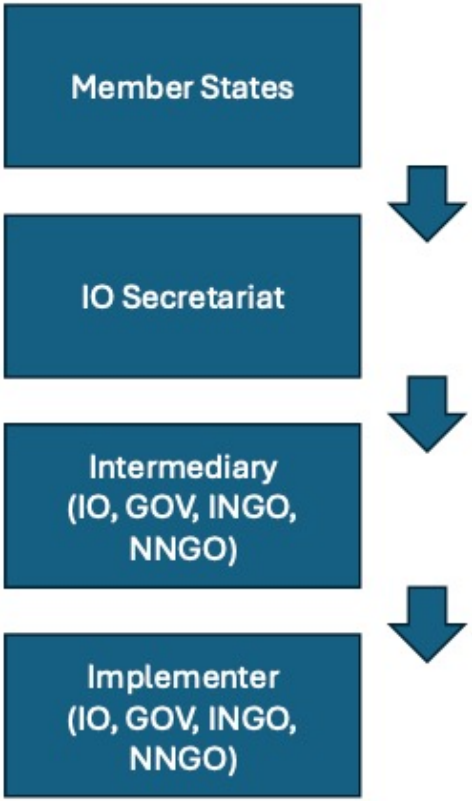
Research Question

If, in service delivery, the IO is consistently interdependent with internal and external actors, who is the IO?

Argument

- Dichotomous view of IOs as member states and bureaucracies focused on agenda-setting offers only partial view of contemporary IOs.
- In service delivery, IOs often serve as **intermediary** in contract between IO (member states or bureaucracy) and external actors.
- Implications
  - Loss of control for member states over agents outside of organization
  - Loss of normative focus or selection of third-party actors

Service Delivery Contract



Research Design Overview

- Multi-Partner Trust Fund Network Data
  - Pooled Funding - distributes risk
  - IO manages fund
  - Allocates to IO, INGO, Gov, NNGO
- Case Study - Democratic Republic of Congo
  - Most-likely case
  - Large country - requires multiple aid actors
  - Weak state capacity
  - High density of humanitarian, development, and peacebuilding actors

Creating a Network Dataset

- Full data
  - 32 UN peace operations
  - starting in or after 2005 and before 2021
  - 20 conflict-affected states
- Capturing two primary relationships
  - Contractual edges (i.e., aid contracts)
    - UN Multi-Partner Trust Fund
    - OECD Creditor Reporting System Bulk Data
    - International Aid Transparency Initiative Datastore
  - Coordination edges (i.e., affiliation)
    - UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs Documents
    - Donor coordination

Network Data: Country-Year Scope

- Burundi, 2006–2021
- Central African Republic, 2007–2021
- Chad, 2007–2010
- Colombia, 2016–2021
- Côte d'Ivoire, 2010–2017
- DRC, 2010–2021
- Guinea-Bissau, 2010–2020
- Haiti, 2017–2021
- Lebanon, 2007–2021
- Libya, 2011–2021
- Mali, 2013–2021
- Myanmar, 2018–2021
- Nepal, 2007–2010
- Sierra Leone, 2005–2014
- Somalia, 2013–2021
- South Sudan, 2011–2021
- Sudan, 2005–2021
- Syria, 2015–2021
- Timor-Leste, 2006–2012
- Yemen, 2012–2021

Actor Type Definitions (1)

- **Bilateral donor or actor:** A state entity funding and/or carrying out the provision of goods and services outside of its territory.
- **IGOs:** A formal organization whose members are states, with three or more member states.
- **Host Government:** The government on whose territory the provision of goods and services is conducted. For United Nations (UN) definitions, the host government specifically hosts UN operations, activities, and programs, though other definitions are broadened to include any external actor. For this dataset, the relevant goods or services may also be provided by a domestic actor.

Actor Type Definitions (2)

- **INGOs:** A nongovernmental, not-for-profit, formal organization active in more than one country and whose primary purpose is advocacy and/or service delivery. To be considered an INGO, the organization does not need to be based in multiple countries; it is sufficient if it operates in more than one country. In contrast to an IGO, an INGO is not established by inter-governmental agreement (UIA 2023).
- **NNGOs:** A nongovernmental, not-for-profit, formal, organization that is active in only one country and whose primary purpose is advocacy and/or service delivery. In addition, the advocacy and/or service delivery carried out by an NGO should extend to society at large rather than only the organization's membership. We also consider umbrella organizations that coordinate the activities of multiple NNGOs as NNGOs themselves.

Actor Type Definitions (3)

- **International Civil Society:** A nongovernmental, not-for-profit organization that is active in more than one country and does not fit the definition of INGO stated above (the primary purpose is not advocacy and/or service delivery). To be considered an international civil society organization, the actor does not need to be based in multiple countries; it is sufficient if it operates in more than one country. These groups are founded upon furthering interests other than advocacy or service — for example, religious, professional, or academic interests.
- **National Civil Society**: A nongovernmental, not-for-profit organization that is active in only one country and does not fit the definition of NNGO stated above (the primary purpose is not advocacy and/or service delivery). National civil society organizations operate in the civic space and may have different primary purposes, such as religious, professional, or academic interests.

Actor Type Definitions (4)

- **International Company:** A for-profit organization that is active in more than one country (Ford 2015, Schouten and Miklian 2020). This includes for-profit development contractors or vendors (Brunt and Casey 2022, Nagaraj 2015). Companies included in this category are not necessarily private, as state-owned enterprises are also included.
- **National Company**: A for-profit organization that is active in only one country (Ford 2015, Schouten and Miklian 2020).

Setting up the network

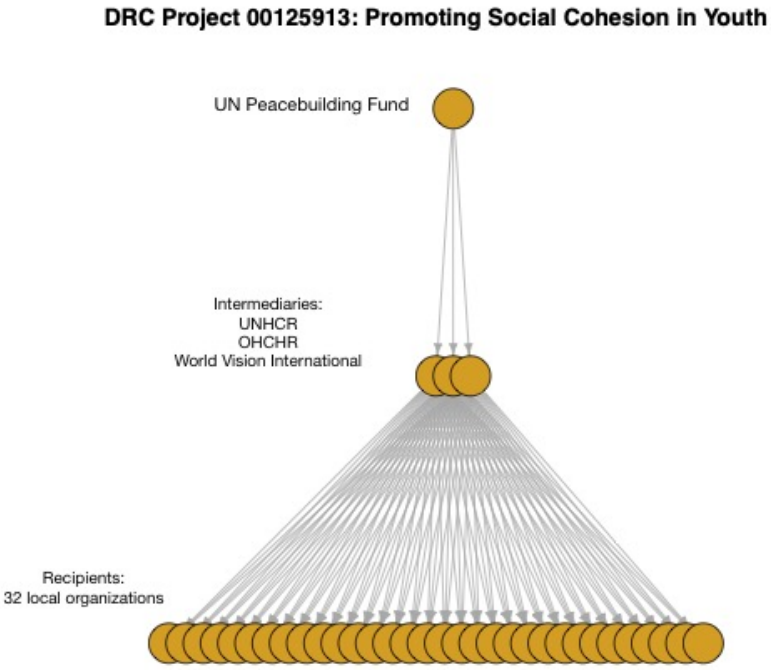
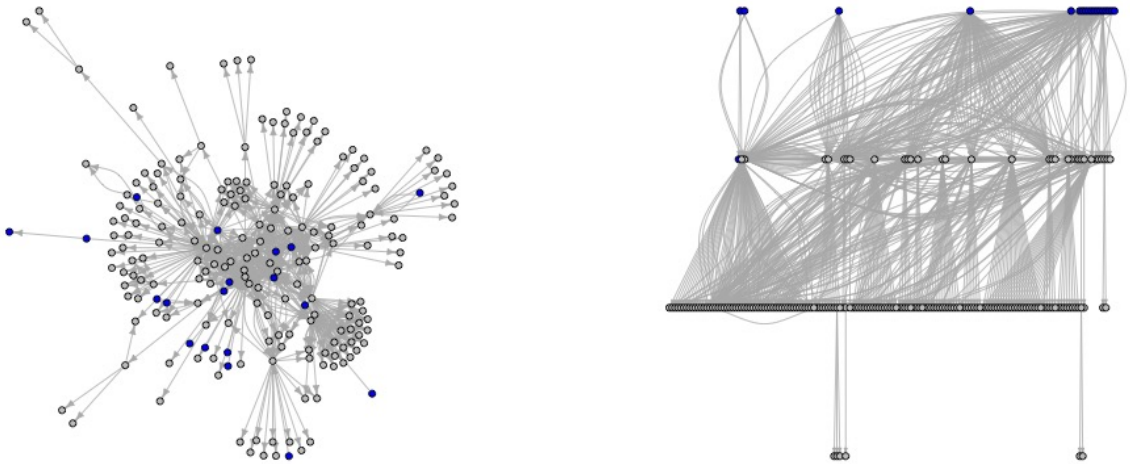


Figure 1: Single Project in DRC from Peacebuilding Fund

Setting up the network



(a) Standard network (b) As a tree

Figure 2: Total Network of MPTF in DRC

Blue nodes are funds

In and Out Degree

Entity	Outgoing	Ingoing	Organization Type
UNDP	80	55	IGO
DRC Gov	0	53	GOV
UNICEF	9	24	IGO
UN Population Fund	26	23	IGO
DRC Humanitarian Fund	78	0	FUND

Table 1: Out and In Degrees of Note

Exponential Random Graph Model

Table 2: ERGM Model Predicting Likelihood

	Edge variable:	
	Estimate	Probability
Baseline Probability	-4.895***	0.7%
IO to IO	-1.489**	0.02%
IO to NNGO	1.181***	2.4%
IO to Government	3.16***	14.9%
IO to INGO	2.122***	5.88%
Akaike Inf. Crit.	4,185.004	
Bayesian Inf. Crit.	4,320.541	
Note: Baseline = NGO to NGO	*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01	

Networks by Project Sector: Health

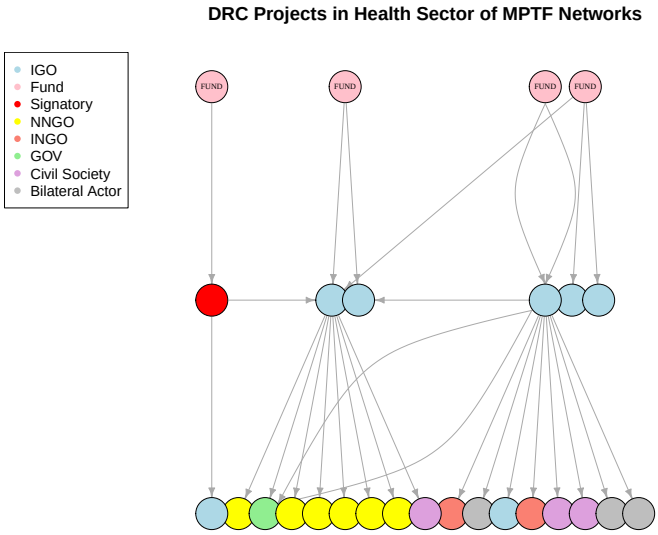


Figure 3: Health Sector Tree

Networks by Project Sector: Security

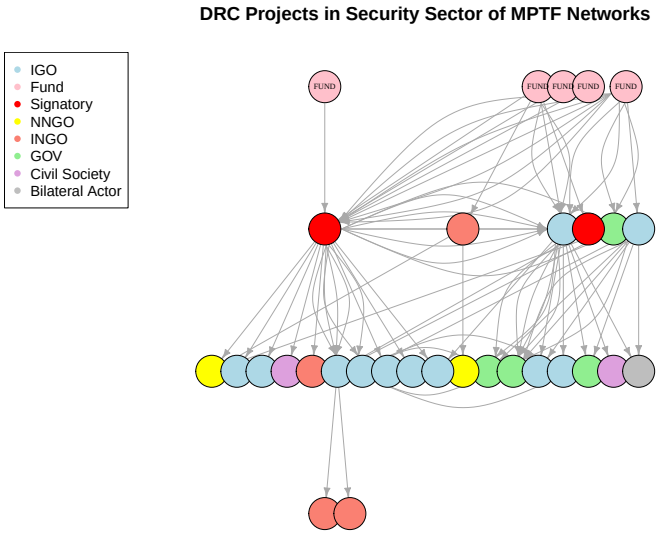


Figure 4: Security Sector Tree

Conclusion

- Current IO scholarship focuses on member states and the headquarters bureaucracy (Secretariat)
- Current IO scholarship focuses on policy agenda setting (including via orchestration), not policy implementation
- In reality:
  - IOs engage in a large amount of policy implementation and service delivery
  - IO service delivery relies on the capacity of actors outside of the IO
  - IO establishes contracts with a range of actors creating long delegation chains.
- We argue IOs increasingly play **intermediary role** - 'middlemen' in internal-external delegation chains
  - Increases IO's control because they act as principals. Introducing contracting and disbursement logic into IO behavior.
  - Decreases IO's control over content of delivery and norm diffusion because the front-line organizations are often not the IO.

Next steps

- Research note with network as outcome vs. full article with non-network outcome
- Dive into variation by sector
- Dive into the rules around contracts, tracing a few cases
- Theorize and discuss host-government veto role

Grateful for your feedback or suggestions!

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Logistic Regression Approach

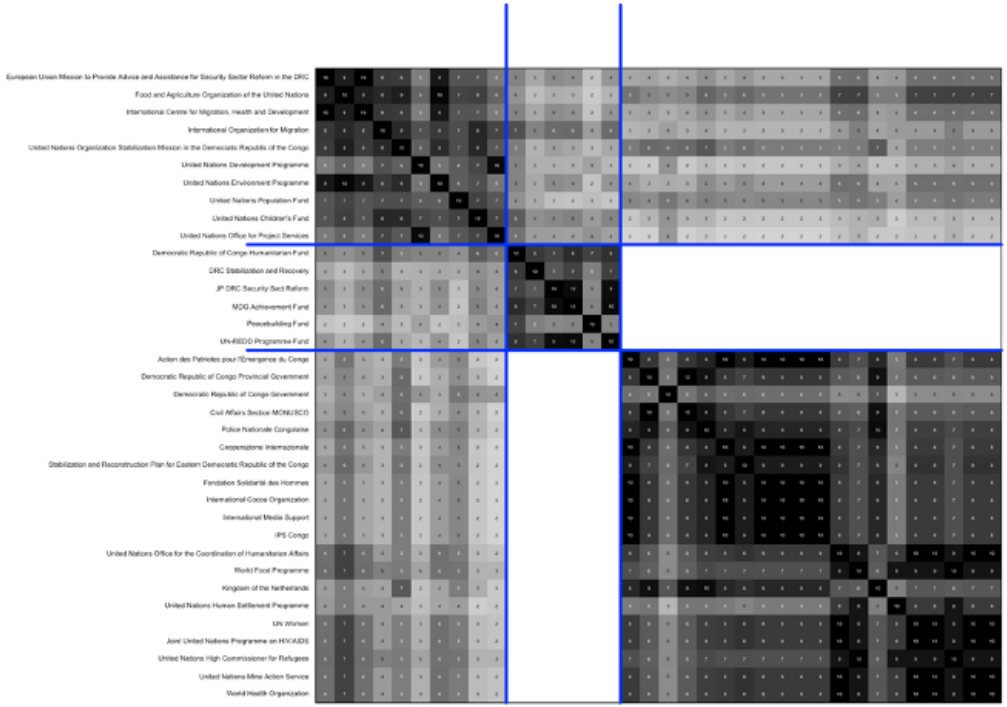
- Network analysis shows likelihood of ties given other possible connections
- Another way to test our theory is at the project level, identifying what entity the funds end with

Table 3: Predicted Probabilities of Multinomial Logistic Regression [1]

	Domestic Gov	IO	NNGO	INGO
No Intermediary	2.17%	77.79%	0.00%	7.32%
Intermediary	56.6%	2.14%	18.35%	11.29%

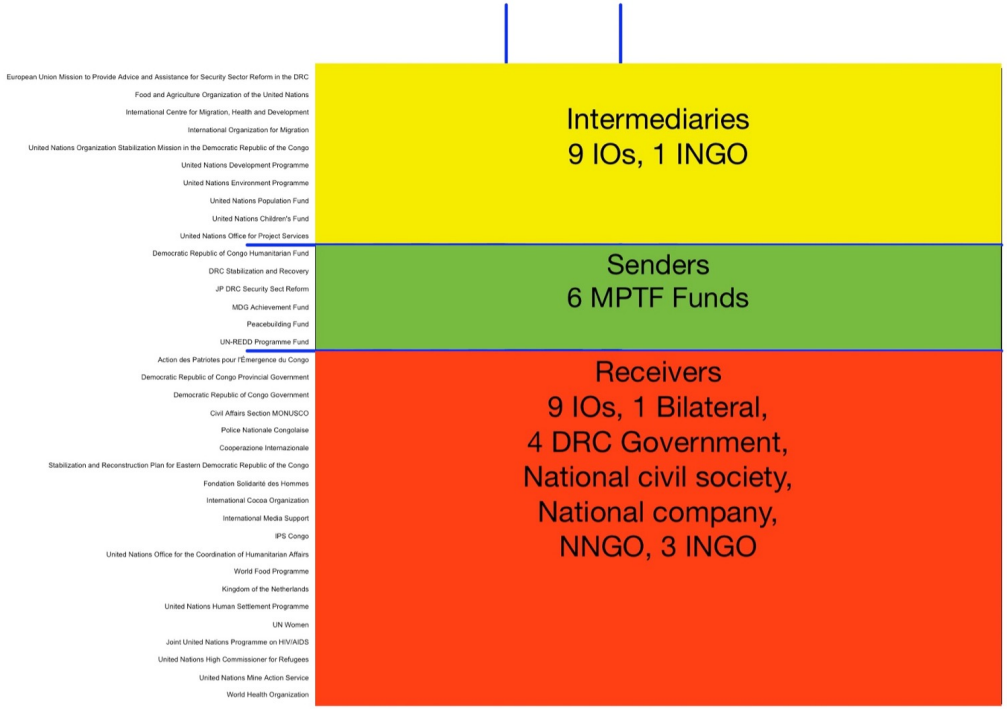
[1] Controlling for number of contract years, previous partnership, government signatory, year trend, development issue, human security issue

Blockmodel: Structurally similar network actors



* all values in cells were multiplied by 10

Blockmodel Depiction



* all values in cells were multiplied by 10

UN Peace Operations in Full Data (1)

- Burundi:
  - UN Integrated Office in Burundi (BINUB)
  - UN Office in Burundi (BNUB)
  - United Nations Electoral Observation Mission in Burundi (MENUB)
  - Office of the Special Envoy for Burundi
- Central African Republic:
  - UN Integrated Peacebuilding Support Office in the Central African Republic (BINUCA)
  - United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilisation Mission in the Central African Republic (MINUSCA)
- Chad and CAR:
  - United Nations Mission in the Central African Republic and Chad (MINURCAT)
- Colombia:
  - UN Mission in Colombia
  - UN Verification Mission in Colombia (UNVMC)
- Côte d'Ivoire:
  - United Nations Operation in Côte d'Ivoire (UNOCI)
- DRC:
  - United Nations Organisation Stabilisation Mission in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (MONUSCO)

UN Peace Operations in Full Data (2)

- Guinea-Bissau:
  - UN Integrated Peacebuilding Office in Guinea-Bissau
- Haiti:
  - United Nations Mission for Justice Support in Haiti (MINUJUSTH)
  - United Nations Integrated Office in Haiti (BINUH)
- Lebanon:
  - Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon (UNSCOL)
- Libya:
  - United Nations Support Mission in Libya
- Mali:
  - Multidimensional Integrated Stabilisation Mission in Mali (MINUSMA)
- Myanmar:
  - Special Envoy Myanmar
- Nepal:
  - UN Mission in Nepal (UNMIN)
- Sierra Leone:
  - UN Integrated Office in Sierra Leone (UNIOSIL)
  - UN Integrated Peacebuilding Office in Sierra Leone (UNIPSIL)

UN Peace Operations in Full Data (3)

- Somalia:
  - The United Nations Assistance Mission in Somalia (UNSOM)
- Sudan & S. Sudan:
  - Special Envoy Sudan and South Sudan
- South Sudan:
  - United Nations Mission in the Republic of South Sudan (UNMISS)
- Syria:
  - Special Envoy for Syria
- Timor-Leste:
  - United Nations Integrated Mission in Timor-Leste
- Sudan:
  - United Nations Mission in the Sudan
  - United Nations/African Union Mission in Darfur (UNAMID)
  - United Nations Interim Security Force for Abyei (UNISFA)
  - UN Integrated Transition Assistance Mission in Sudan (UNITAMS)
- Yemen:
  - Special Envoy to the Secretary General for Yemen
  - UN Mission to Support the Hudaydah Agreement

UN Peace Operation Inclusion Criteria

- Mandate must have the purposes of responding to violence through keeping peace or preventing future conflict in conflict-affected states
- Mandates must begin after January 1, 2005
- Mandate must be multidimensional and related to conflict and peace, development, and/or humanitarian programming
- **Operations are also included for continuity of UN presence over different operations**, e.g., in Burundi
  - BINUB (2006-2010)
  - BNUB (2011-2014)
  - MENUB (2014-2015)
  - Office of the Special Envoy for Burundi (2016-2021)

UN Peace Operation Exclusion Criteria

- Started before 2005 or after 2021 (e.g., UNAMA [2002] in Afghanistan)
- Mandates which are regional or not specific to the host country (e.g., Special Envoy for the Great Lakes or The United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia [UNRCCA])
- Mandates which are very limited in scope (e.g., UN International Commission of Inquiry mandated to establish the facts and circumstances of the events of 28 September 2009 in Guinea)
- Mandates unrelated to ongoing conflict (e.g., International Commission Against Impunity in Guatemala [CICIG] or Personal Envoy Mozambique)
- Operations that last less than one year (e.g., United Nations Supervision Mission in Syria [UNSMIS])

Contractual Edges Definition

- A contractual agreement is defined by two+ organizations using their own funds to implement a project with money transferred and having a clearly specified goal, time frame, and deliverable(s). Contractual agreements are typically "projects". We record the project's ID in a dedicated column for projects to allow for the linking organizations to projects. We count each contractual agreement; by counting the number of contracts rather than the dollar amount, we choose the most reliable and valid measure of a relationship; more contracts indicate a choice to repeatedly engage.
- Contractual relationships are directed from bilateral, multilateral, or foundation donors. Bilateral refers to a single state funding an organization directly through a project. This encompasses Official Development Assistance (ODA) and ODA-like aid that states provide countries. Multilateral donors include funds or banks with member states, UN agencies and offices, as well as multi-donor & multi-partner trust funds.

Structured Coordination (Affiliation) Edges Definitions

- The **UN Cluster system** is a coordination structure, with clusters (11) typically led by a UN agency, to facilitate distribution of responsibilities, pooled resources, and hierarchical reporting structures. The lead is a UN agency, but they sometimes have co-leads that are non-UN organizations.
- **Sectoral coordination structures** bring together actors that work in a similar sector or issue-area. These structures are separate from UN Clusters but may work in similar fields. Only sectors which relate to development/humanitarian programming or peacekeeping will be included in the dataset.
- **Donor coordination structures** bring together donors that provide funding to the relevant country. These structures are typically designed to avoid duplication of effort, and aid clustering (funding the same sector/geographic area and ignoring others). Only donor coordination structures that are unique to the relevant country will be included. To elaborate, structures that work on the global or regional level will not be included.

Indirect Affiliation Edges Definitions

- **Sector affiliation** refers to the thematic area relevant to the projects we are coding. Our sectoral classification is based on two levels: sector (22) and sub-sector (343). We code at the sector level by aggregating sub-sector information up from the OECD Purpose Codes. We used the UN Cluster system and the 2004 Utstein Peacebuilding Palette to develop the sectors list.
- Organizations that are present in or that are involved in a project implemented in the same **geographic location** may be connected to one another. We include geographic location as a type of indirect network tie. The political administrative level that we use for coding geographic locations is the "Admin Level 1".